Markdown PDF Plus themes

Cross-platform light and dark PDF export styling for VS Code and the **Markdown PDF Plus** extension. The repository includes two installer scripts:

- `linux-install.sh` — installs the themes for the current Linux user.
- `windows-install.ps1` — installs the themes for the current Windows user.

Both installers locate `pdf-light.css` and `pdf-dark.css` **within the same repository checkout as the installer**, including nested subdirectories. They do not depend on the checkout name, checkout path, or current working directory. Each CSS filename must occur exactly once in the repository.

Install on Linux

Step 1 — Change directory to the repository

Open a terminal and navigate to the folder where you cloned the repository. Replace the example path with your actual checkout location:

```
cd "$HOME/code/Markdown-PDF-Config"
```

Step 2 — Update installer permissions

Make the installation script executable. **Do not use sudo**; the script installs themes only for your current user.

```
chmod +x ./linux-install.sh
```

Step 3 — Execute the installer

```
./linux-install.sh
```

Alternatively, you can run the installer directly from any directory without changing permissions:

```
sh "$HOME/code/Markdown-PDF-Config/linux-install.sh"
```

The installer determines the repository location from its own path, so it works even if you clone the repository somewhere else. No administrator access is required.

Install on Windows

Step 1 — Change directory to the repository

Open **PowerShell** and navigate to the folder where you cloned the repository. Replace the example path if necessary:

```
& {
    Set-Location 'C:\Users\csavugot\code\Markdown-PDF-Config'
}
```

Step 2 — Check the installer file

Confirm that `windows-install.ps1` exists in the current repository directory:

```
& {
    Get-Item -LiteralPath '.\windows-install.ps1'
}
```

No `chmod` or administrator privileges are required on Windows. The following command uses a process-scoped execution-policy override, without changing your user or system policy. Organization-enforced restrictions may still prevent execution.

Step 3 — Execute the installer

```
& {
    $Installer = (Resolve-Path -LiteralPath '.\windows-install.ps1').Path
    powershell.exe -NoProfile -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File $Installer
}
```

Alternatively, execute the script from any directory by providing its full path:

```
& {
    powershell.exe -NoProfile -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File 'C:\Users\csavugot\code\Markdown-PDF-Config\windows-install.ps1'
}
```

The Windows installer uses its own script location rather than the current directory to find the CSS files. No administrator privileges are required. If your organization enforces application-control or execution restrictions, follow its policy rather than modifying system-wide settings.

Installation destination

Both systems use `~/.config/Code/markdown-themes/` as the theme directory:

```
~/.config/Code/markdown-themes/
├── pdf-light.css
└── pdf-dark.css
```

On Windows, `~` refers to your Windows user profile (for example, `C:\Users\csavugot`). The installer deliberately uses this shared path **rather than** the default Windows `%APPDATA%\Code` settings location, so your `CSSPath` setting can remain identical across operating systems.

Re-running an installer skips identical files. If an installed theme has changed, the installer creates a timestamped `.bak-*` copy before replacing it. The installers do **not** modify your VS Code user settings or install extensions.

Configure VS Code

Install the **Markdown PDF Plus** extension and open **Preferences: Open User Settings (JSON)**. Add these settings inside the existing settings object (without duplicating keys):

```jsonc
// ============================================================
// Markdown Formatting Settings — Windows + Linux
// ============================================================
"markdown-preview-github-styles.colorTheme": "auto",
"markdown.preview.scrollEditorWithPreview": false,
"markdown.preview.scrollPreviewWithEditor": true,
"markdown-pdf-plus.pageSize": "letter",
"markdown-pdf-plus.usePageStyleFromCSS": true,

// DARK — uncomment both lines to select
// "markdown-pdf-plus.CSSPath": "~/.config/Code/markdown-themes/pdf-dark.css",
// "markdown-pdf-plus.outputHome": "./pdfs/dark",

// LIGHT — comment both lines to select dark instead
"markdown-pdf-plus.CSSPath": "~/.config/Code/markdown-themes/pdf-light.css",
"markdown-pdf-plus.outputHome": "./pdfs/light",

// Leave empty to use the source Markdown basename automatically
"markdown-pdf-plus.outputFilename": "",
```

Keep **exactly one** `CSSPath` and one `outputHome` setting active. PDF exports are saved to the `pdfs/light` or `pdfs/dark` subdirectory relative to your Markdown document. Output filenames keep the Markdown document's basename; do not use `${fileBasenameNoExtension}` in `outputFilename`, because this extension treats it literally.

Verify

1. Run the installer and confirm it reports both CSS files as **Installed** or **Unchanged**.
2. Confirm both files exist in `~/.config/Code/markdown-themes/`.
3. In VS Code, open a Markdown document and select **Markdown PDF Plus: Export PDF** from the Command Palette.
4. Check that the PDF appears in the expected `pdfs/light` or `pdfs/dark` folder and uses the selected colors.
5. Toggle the two active theme-specific settings to test the other theme.

Mermaid diagram caveat

Markdown documents containing explicit Mermaid theme colors cannot reliably be rethemed using only the outer CSS. Where necessary, maintain theme-specific Mermaid diagrams or parameterize their theme settings. Earlier examples used `SAM_Overview_Proposal_Light.md` and `SAM_Overview_Proposal_Dark(1).md`.

The theme CSS may be scoped to `@media print` to avoid changing the GitHub-style Markdown preview. The final PDF can also depend on Markdown PDF Plus stylesheet ordering; if an override is ineffective, inspect the export and adjust selector specificity.